



10 vi / Emacs
vi and Emacs are text editors that are highly favoured by hardcore programmers and hackers. Countless forum threads exist solely to debate which is better, but there is no consensus. Both are operated entirely using the keyboard with text commands that can greatly improve the speed with which you handle text and code once you get used to them.

7 jQuery
Possibly the most famous javascript library for developing web applications, jQuery packs a lot of features in just a few kB of code. jQuery makes it incredibly simple to work with HTML documents, and is even in use in non-HTML DOM environments. It has been espoused by major companies such as Microsoft, Google and Nokia.



4 LLVM
LLVM or Low Level Virtual Machine is a new compiler infrastructure, capable of compiling a number of languages. It is what is responsible for compiling from Flash to an iOS application in the iPhone packager as well. It is capable of optimising code at various instances, and can even work with GCC. It is part of Apple's development tools as well.



3 Git / TortoiseGit
Git is the version control system of choice for Linux kernel developers, and is in fact designed by Linus Torvalds himself. Git is now widely used with social coding sites such as Gitorius and Github both of which are free for open source projects. TortoiseGit allows one to manage Git repositories using a GUI.



9 Mercurial / TortoiseHg
Mercurial is a brilliant distributed version control system that is used for some big applications, such as Firefox. TortoiseHg provides a graphical interface for managing Mercurial repositories on Windows and Linux. Mercurial is open-source, cross-platform, easy to use, and efficient. It can be integrated into many other developer tools such as Eclipse to make development even easier.



6 Adobe AIR SDK
The Adobe AIR SDK puts to use the development talents of the web developer and enables them to create desktop applications for Windows, Linux, Mac OS X, Android and iPhone using web development languages and tools. Adobe AIR applications install on computers with the AIR runtime installed and can be written in Flash (ActionScript 3 and MXML) or even HTML, CSS and JavaScript (including HTML5).



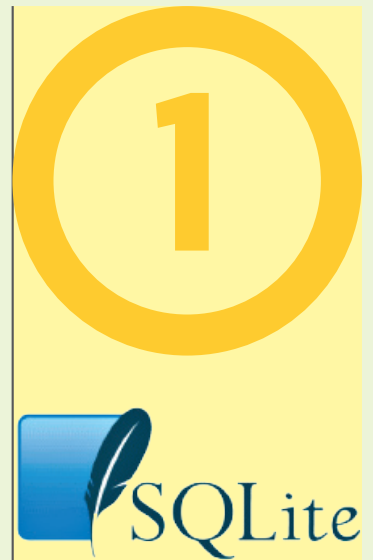
8 Qt/QtCreator
Qt, now by Nokia, is an extensive cross-platform SDK that is behind the KDE desktop environment for Linux. It allows developers to create applications for Windows, Linux and Mac OS X while maintaining the platform's unique look with changes to their code. Qt is also the future development platform for Nokia devices. QtCreator is the official IDE for developing Qt applications that includes a GUI builder.



5 Eclipse
Eclipse is one of the most popular IDEs out there, and is capable for developing in a plethora of languages from C / C++, to COBOL, PHP and Ruby. It is free and open source, software and is constantly improving with each new version. It is highly extensible and serves as a base for a number of other IDEs such as Zend Studio, Flash Builder and Aptana.



2 GCC
The GNU Compiler collection is the default compiler used on Unix-like systems. It supports a wide number of programming languages, operating systems and architectures. Installing GCC is a prerequisite to compiling any Linux software from source and is probably what was used to compile all the software you have installed on your Linux system.



SQLite

It might seem like an odd entry for the top spot, but SQLite really is remarkable. It is possibly the most deployed open source software in the world! It is an embeddable SQL database that is used by a number of open source and proprietary software. It is used in popular applications such as iTunes, iOS, Acrobat Reader, Adobe AIR, Firefox, Android, Symbian and many more. Unlike most other open source software, SQLite is in the public domain, which means that it can be used for any purposes whatsoever, including in proprietary applications, for a charge without releasing the source code. The SQLite application and library are small and can be used with a number of programming languages to give your application a SQL database for storing structured data. The syntax of SQL is quite similar to MySQL and standard SQL syntax. For its use in millions of devices and applications we believe SQLite to be the number one software for developers.